

HRISHIKESH JOSHI

Senior Systems Administrator | Azure Solutions Architect (AZ-305)

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SUMMARY

Senior Systems Administrator with 11+ years of enterprise infrastructure experience across hybrid cloud, on-premises, and Microsoft 365 environments. Deep hands-on ownership of Azure compute, networking, hybrid identity (Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA), BCDR (Azure Site Recovery), and endpoint security across a multi-client managed services portfolio covering pharmaceutical, manufacturing, renewable energy, and software companies. Track record spans ransomware recovery at scale, automated CVE remediation pipelines, Azure cost governance against BOQ commitments, OT/IT integration under GxP, and pre-sales solution architecture combining deep technical delivery with customer-facing documentation and governance.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Systems Administrator & Cloud Architect

I- Source Info Systems Pvt. Ltd

01/2021 – Present | Pune, IN

- Design, deploy, and operate enterprise infrastructure across Microsoft Azure and private cloud for a multi-client portfolio spanning pharmaceutical, manufacturing, renewable energy, and software companies - 1,000+ users and 500+ servers at 99.9% availability.
- Architected Azure VM Scale Sets in flexible orchestration mode with golden-image creation, versioning, and automated patch lifecycle management, reducing manual provisioning effort and standardizing deployments.
- Led Azure Site Recovery implementation for business-critical workloads - replication policy design, failover testing, and BCDR documentation - improving RTO/RPO posture and compliance readiness.
- Implemented hybrid identity with Azure AD Connect (Password Hash Sync) across 10+ client environments; designed Conditional Access and MFA policies enforcing Zero Trust access with no user productivity impact.
- Led ransomware recovery of 100+ compromised servers: rebuilt and hardened Windows security baselines, deployed next-generation antivirus, and rolled out Zscaler proxy across 500+ endpoints through to full restoration of operations.
- Designed and POC-validated a multi-tenant Database Activity Monitoring (DAM) solution on OpenSearch with document-level security and agentless WEF/OpenWEC log collection from SQL Server.
- Drove an Intune co-management exit for a Microsoft Entra hybrid-joined Windows 11 fleet - ConfigMgr client removal and native Update Ring policy configuration - inside an AppLocker/WDAC-restricted environment where PowerShell execution is blocked.
- Operate daily Microsoft Defender Antivirus fleet-health reporting across a 245-endpoint estate through a formula-driven Excel dashboard; diagnosed definition-update failures including a TLS/network-path fault in the Windows Update Agent channel.
- Own Azure cost governance for client subscriptions: monthly BOQ-to-actual reconciliation and variance tracking across DDoS Protection, Azure Site Recovery, bandwidth, and reserved instances.
- Executing a P2V migration of a physical industrial PC to Hyper-V for a GxP-regulated pharmaceutical OT environment, resolving cross-subnet SCADA polling and OT/IT network segmentation.
- Monitor estate health with Zabbix, PRTG, LogRhythm SIEM, and Azure Monitor; automate provisioning with PowerShell, Terraform, and ARM/Bicep;

Senior IT Engineer

Minitek Systems India Pvt. Ltd. | Client: KSPG Automotive India Pvt. Ltd

01/2016 - 05/2021 | Pune, IN

- Managed and monitored Windows Server 2008/2012 environments, ensuring continuous system availability, optimal performance, and security compliance
- Administered Active Directory user and group accounts, enforcing Group Policy Objects (GPOs) and access controls aligned with organizational security standards

EDUCATION

Certified Cloud Computing & IT Infrastructure Professional

Jetking Technologies

2012 - 2014 | Pune, India

SKILLS

Azure Compute & Storage

Azure Virtual Machines | VM Scale Sets (VMSS)

Azure Backup | Azure File Sync

Azure Storage | Recovery Services Vault

Azure Networking

Azure Virtual Network | Application Gateway

Azure Load Balancer | Azure Firewall

Azure Bastion | VPN Gateway | NSG

DNS | WAF

Azure Security & Identity

Microsoft Entra ID | Azure AD Connect

Conditional Access | Azure RBAC

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

Privileged Identity Management

Disaster Recovery & BCDR

Azure Site Recovery (ASR)

Business Continuity Planning

RTO/RPO Optimization | Backup Policies

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate

AZ-104

Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert

AZ-305

Microsoft Certified: Windows Server Hybrid Administrator Associate

AZ-800 / AZ-801

Microsoft 365 Certified: Enterprise Administrator Expert

MS-102

Microsoft 365 Certified Messaging Administrator

MS-203

Cisco Certified: Cybersecurity Essentials & Introduction to Cybersecurity

Information Security

- Deployed OS and application patches using ManageEngine Desktop Central, maintaining endpoint compliance and reducing vulnerability exposure across the enterprise
- Executed system image deployments using Windows Deployment Services (WDS) and Microsoft Deployment Toolkit (MDT), standardizing endpoint configurations across 500+ devices
- Administered enterprise backup operations using IBM Tivoli Storage Manager and TS2900 tape library, ensuring data protection and recovery readiness
- Managed and tracked IT service requests and incidents using ManageEngine ServiceDesk Plus, maintaining SLA adherence and service quality
- Coordinated with hardware and network vendors to resolve escalated infrastructure issues, minimizing business impact from outages
- Provided remote technical support for enterprise users across India, resolving OS, application, networking, and security incidents efficiently

PROJECTS

Azure Virtual Machine Scale Sets (VMSS) Deployment

- Objective: Enable elastic, auto-scaling infrastructure for client production workloads on Azure
 - Technologies: Azure VMSS, Azure Managed Disks, Azure Monitor, PowerShell, ARM Templates
 - Responsibilities: Designed golden image creation pipeline, configured flexible orchestration, automated patch lifecycle, and integrated monitoring
 - Outcome: Reduced manual VM provisioning effort and improved workload scalability and availability
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Azure Site Recovery (ASR) Implementation for Business Continuity

- Objective: Improve disaster recovery readiness and minimize RTO/RPO for critical production workloads
 - Technologies: Azure Site Recovery, Recovery Services Vault, Azure Virtual Machines, Azure Networking
 - Responsibilities: Architected full ASR deployment, configured replication policies, tested failover procedures, and validated BCDR documentation
 - Outcome: Achieved enterprise-grade disaster recovery posture with automated failover, improving business continuity and compliance readiness
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Hybrid Identity Deployment with Azure AD Connect

- Objective: Unify on-premises Active Directory with Microsoft Entra ID across 10+ client environments
 - Technologies: Azure AD Connect, Password Hash Synchronization, Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA
 - Responsibilities: Configured AD Connect sync, designed Conditional Access policies, enabled MFA, and validated SSO across environments
 - Outcome: Seamless hybrid identity achieved; improved security with Zero Trust access controls and no user productivity disruption
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VMware NSX-V to NSX-T Private Cloud Migration

- Objective: Modernize network virtualization and improve micro-segmentation in a 100+ server private cloud
 - Technologies: VMware NSX-T, NSX-V, vSphere, VXLAN, Distributed Firewall
 - Responsibilities: Planned and executed phased migration from NSX-V to NSX-T, redesigned network topology, and validated security policies post-migration
 - Outcome: Enhanced network security posture, improved scalability, and eliminated NSX-V lifecycle risk
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STRENGTHS

Structured & Detail-Oriented

Designs and configure systems with a clean, standardized, and well-documented approach, ensuring long-term maintainability and smooth handovers for future teams.

Fast, Accurate & Results-Driven

Delivering solutions quickly without compromising quality, helping minimize downtime and prevent operational and financial impact.

Analytical Problem Solver

Takes a methodical approach to troubleshooting by asking the right questions, identifying root causes, and implementing long-term fixes rather than temporary workarounds.

Multitasking & Prioritization

Comfortable managing multiple projects and incidents simultaneously while maintaining service quality and meeting deadlines.